

you understand the material really well, you will benefit from rereading these pages multiple times as your investing life progresses, and you will hurt yourself if you rely solely on the lessons from one reading. First, they fade in your mind. Second, the more you read them, the more you get out of them. Without meaning to sound heretical, it is like a little investing bible—a book that is meant to be read multiple times and whose usefulness does not end with the last page.

You will find lots of other jewels of your own in these pages that may do as much for you as they have for me. But an important concluding point to make on *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits* is to note its sheer fundamentalness. Not only does it teach the true basics of fundamentals of investing, but it has also been a core part of the training of many leading investment practitioners. For many years, it has been part of the curriculum in the investment class at the Stanford Graduate School of Business. Students of all forms passed through Stanford, read the book, and went on to become some of the nation's leading investors. But the book's breadth was broader than that. For example, Warren Buffett has long credited my father and *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits* as being fundamental to the development of his investment philosophy. The first of my father's "Don'ts" in Chapter Nine—"Don't overstress diversification"—gets you quickly to a key cornerstone of Buffettism. And you can find it in the very same place Buffett first did.

Not much of great importance to market fundamentalism changed between the writing of my father's first book and that of his third and last book, *Conservative Investors Sleep Well*. But a lot of water went under the investment bridge: a huge bull market, a huge bear market, 1958 to 1974—lots of fads and fancies. By then my father was sixty-seven. His last book was good, but it wasn't nearly what *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits* was. He had done it so well the first time that his two subsequent books only made incremental additions. If you can read only one of my father's writing, let it be his first book. It was his best. Still, if you want to read more from my father, his next most important writing was his last book. It was also contributing fundamental ideas. It was a bit topical at the time but has remained timeless.

I think in *Conservative Investors Sleep Well* that Chapter Six's Motorola section is vintage Phil Fisher. In it, he shows why Motorola, which others